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THE WHITE HOUSE
WASHINGTON

MEMORANDUM OF TELEPHONE CONVERSATION

SUBJECT: Telcon with Fernando Collor of Brazil on
March 25, 1992 (U)

PARTICIPANTS: The President
Fernando Collor, President of Brazil
Interpreter: Neil Seidenman
Notetaker: William T. Pryce/Robert B. Morley

DATE, TIME March 25, 1992, 8:19 - 8:38am EST
AND PLACE: The Oval Office

The President: Hello, Mr. President. (U)

President Collor: Good morning. It is good to hear your voice.
(U)

The President: It's good to hear yours. How are you? (U)

President Collor: I am just fine, thank God. We are
enthusiastically following your campaign and rooting for your
success. (U)

The President: Yes, well, it is a complicated and sort of ugly
business that takes a lot of time, but that is just the way our
process works every four years. (U)

President Collor: Well, the campaign is a very significant
thing, and we are sure to benefit from your success. (U)

The President: Thanks for your kind words. We are working hard
on it. Now what is on your mind, sir? (U)

President Collor: Mr. President, with your permission, I would
like to raise with you a few points on the United Nations
Conference on the Environment and Development in our country in
June. (U)

The President: Yes. (U)

President Collor: Mr. President, in the first place, I want to
underscore strongly the great importance we assign to you being
here at the conference. We know it is a difficult time for you,
with the election process in your country. But your presence
here would put the finishing touch on our work and insure its
success. You would make a major contribution to the success of
the conference by being here. (U)

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The President: Let me assure you that we are giving this our most serious consideration. I consider this to be a very important meeting. You are right, there are serious scheduling problems because of the ongoing electoral process up here, and I have to give that serious attention. I am still hopeful I can come. I understand and recognize the importance of the meeting not only to you and Brazil, but also to the international community. I hope to participate, but I cannot give you a final commitment right now. (U)

President Collor: Thank you, Mr. President. I have a second point. (U)

The President: Yes. (U)

President Collor: The second point concerns the work of the Preparatory Conference now working in New York. As of their last meeting, there was no final consensus on many issues. This is a source of concern for us, because it may lead to a feeling of disappointment within the world community. It might even cause difficulties with the agenda. It may block progress or cause lengthy discussions within the conference in June, which would jeopardize the conference's success. So, we must make an extra effort to have a consensus in New York. I ask your positive support for this. (U)

The President: We agree on the importance of the meeting. I've been advised that progress has been made on issues. But more needs to be done. There are understandably differences between us, but we will try to work out a consensus. We all want the conference to be a success. We know what is at stake here. (U)

President Collor: Thank you very much for that, Mr. President. I also wanted to point out that I will be meeting with your Ambassador on Friday, and will make all the points with him. I hope he will report our conversation to you. Our position on all matters is fully valid, but we are quite open to discussion. This conference is important to us. (U)

I also wanted to add a word of appreciation for your help on our debt problem. The role of David Mulford has been especially useful. This demonstrates the regard you hold for Brazil. It shows your friendship for Brazil. (U)

I would like to appeal to you as a friend. I feel I am a friend. Speaking as a friend, I feel it is important that the United States hold on to the leadership of the conference we are going to have. It must go forward with the leadership of the United States. This is very significant, only with your leadership can we hope to mobilize world opinion. We cannot lose ground. Time is of the essence and that is why I wish to reinforce the importance of your presence. (U)

Thank you again. (U)

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The President: I know you speak as a friend. We are committed to see you succeed in Brazil, and I also want this conference to succeed. As a result of this call, I will contact our negotiators and urge them to do what they can to resolve the differences that still exist. But I hope people understand the enormous difficulties we are having in the United States relating to the dynamism of our economy.

I understand there are differences on financing questions in New York. We, and not just we, but others want the World Bank to be involved. But you are a friend, and we want to work our problems out. We don't just want to go down to Rio without knowing we will be successful. You have made an appeal. We want you to succeed. I hope we can work out the problems, but I also hope that you understand what I have to do because of the economy. We don't want the conference to flounder on details. We'll keep pushing at this end. (U)

I agree with you on the question of the importance of leadership and influencing world opinion. We will work out things at the conference. This is not just political talk. I'm giving very serious consideration to this. We want to give the conference every chance of success. I will get back to you as soon as I can after I have talked to our negotiators. (U)

President Collor: Thank you, Mr. President. I understand all that you have said, and again, U.S. leadership at the conference is very important. I understand the United States has its own problems and is not in a position to set limits on emissions and so forth. But we think your leadership is essential. You personally cannot afford to lose that leadership. I say this as a friend. We want the conference to go forward with your leadership. (U)

Thanks again for your time and the opportunity to talk to you. My best regard to you, Barbara and the family. I hope to see you soon. (U)

The President: Love to you and your family. I want you to know we appreciate all that you are trying to do and the success Brazil has had under your leadership. (U)

President Collor: Thank you very much. Good-bye. (U)

The President: Good-bye. (U)

-- End of Conversation --

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